

TidyTuesday Week 38

Pranay Gundam

Wednesday 16th September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the corner of the internet where we throw two unrelated economic series into a blender every day and act surprised when soup comes out. This week's contestants included a heavy rotation of California house prices, a couple of discontinued banking indicators that FRED clearly keeps around out of sentimentality, and — for spice — Japanese retail inventory sentiment and the carbon dioxide emissions of commercial-sector distillate fuel. Truly the crossover episodes nobody demanded.

We kicked things off Monday with Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura house prices versus the gross fixed investment of financial businesses in equipment, software, and structures, a series so discontinued it stopped reporting in 2017 and still got dragged into this. The raw regression posted an R-squared of 0.87 and a p-value with more zeros after the decimal than I have patience to count, which is the statistical equivalent of a fireworks show. Except, of course, it's two things that both went up for fifty years. Once we detrended and stripped out that shared "everything drifts upward over time" magic, the R-squared face-planted to 0.23. Still technically significant, sure, but it went from "soulmates" to "we follow each other on LinkedIn." Classic trend mirage, exactly the kind of thing this project exists to point and laugh at.

Tuesday brought San Luis Obispo house prices against the percent of loans that are prime-based by average loan size, and honestly this one had the decency to flop right out of the gate. The raw regression couldn't even clear the significance bar (p around 0.076, R-squared a majestic 0.04), and detrending only made it sadder. No trend mirage, no genuine link, just two series politely ignoring each other. Refreshing, in a way. Then Wednesday served up commercial distillate fuel CO2 emissions versus Japanese retail stock-volume sentiment, which is where it gets mildly interesting: the raw regression showed a positive relationship (R-squared 0.48), but after detrending the sign flipped to negative and it stayed significant at the 0.017 level. So the "real" relationship, insofar as such a phrase is legally permissible here, is the opposite of what the raw version claimed. Dramatic! Meaningful? Absolutely not.

As always, the mandatory reminder: these are randomly paired series with zero causal story and no rigorous statistical claim being made, so please do not go rebalancing your portfolio based on Japanese inventory vibes and diesel fumes. Spurious correlation isn't the occasional bug in this project — it's the entire product. This week the detrending step did its usual job of quietly assassinating one over-hyped raw "finding" and gently roughing up another, which is roughly as much scientific integrity as you can expect from a machine that thinks Ventura County real estate and discontinued financial-investment flows are destiny. See you next week for more of the same

nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-09-14

Series ID: ATNHPIUS37100Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1976-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 6.

Series ID: FBGFIEQ027S

This series is titled Financial business; gross fixed investment, nonresidential equipment, software, and structures, Flow (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1946-10-01 and the observation end date is 2017-10-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S	R-squared:	0.870			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.869			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1103.			
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.84e-75			
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1926.0			
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3856.			
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3862.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.341e+04	3837.676	3.493	0.001	5829.236	2.1e+04
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q	745.7296	22.457	33.207	0.000	701.389	790.070
Omnibus:	1.131	Durbin-Watson:	0.039			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.568	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.803			
Skew:	-0.148	Prob(JB):	0.669			
Kurtosis:	3.165	Cond. No.	341.			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

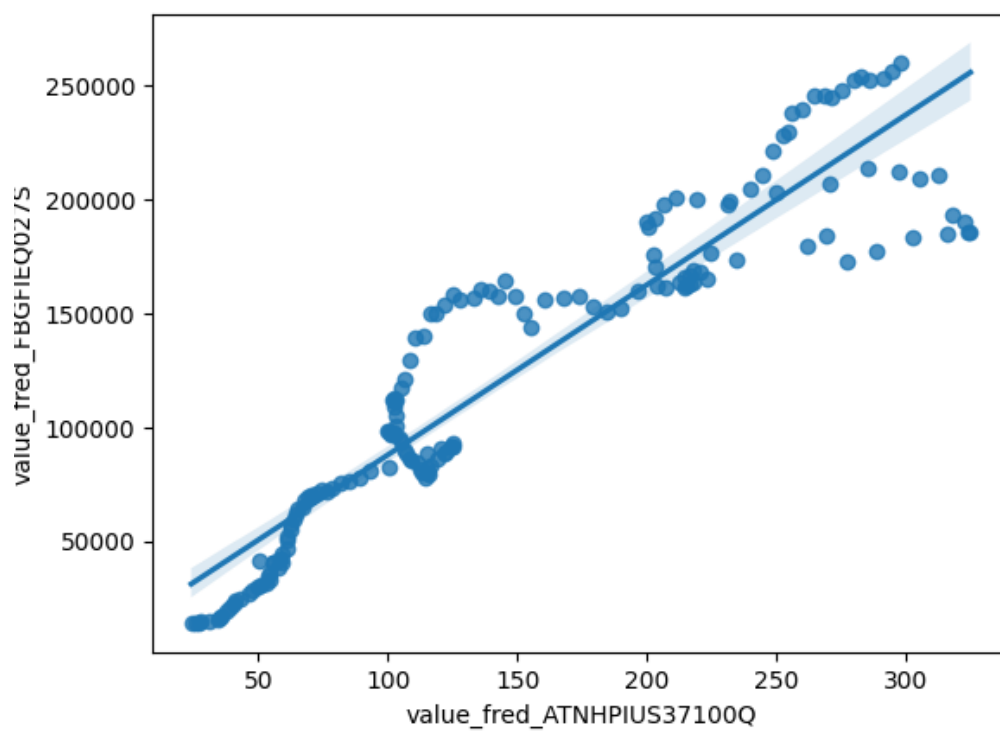


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S_detrended	R-squared:	0.233
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.228
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	50.05
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.06e-11
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1814.4
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3633.
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3639.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.573e-09	985.135	-1.6e-12	1.000	-1945.095	1945.095
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q_detrended	197.7479	27.952	7.075	0.000	142.559	252.937

Omnibus:	3.074	Durbin-Watson:	0.100
Prob(Omnibus):	0.215	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.616
Skew:	-0.248	Prob(JB):	0.270
Kurtosis:	3.361	Cond. No.	35.2

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

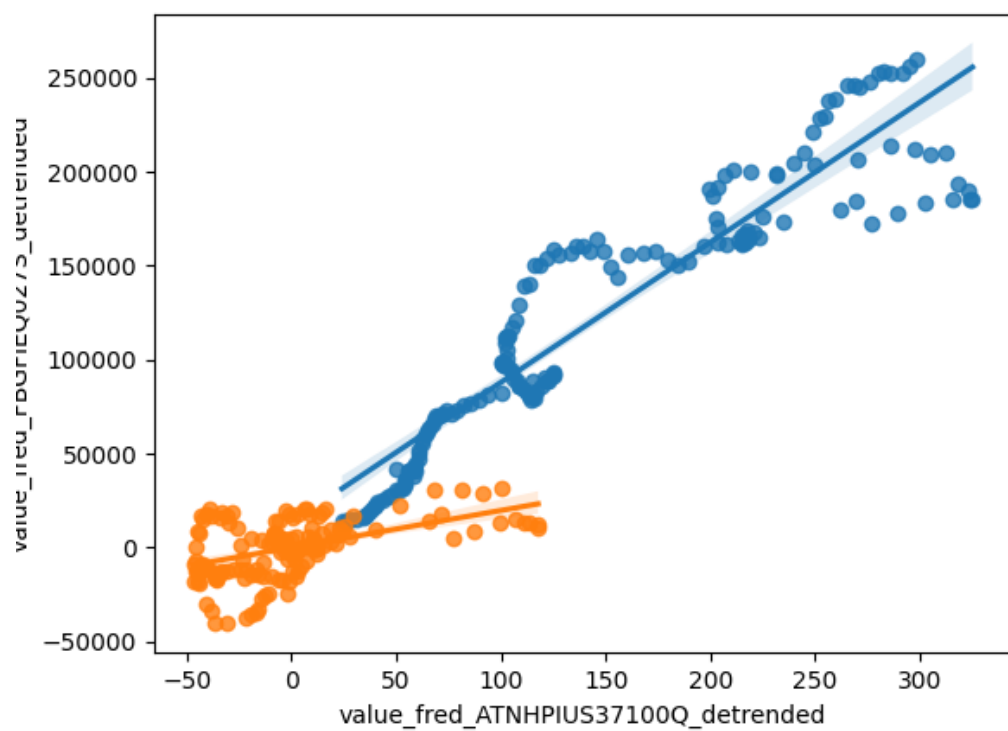


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

3 Date: 2026-09-15

Series ID: ATNHPIUS42020Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for San Luis Obispo-Paso Robles, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1977-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 8.

Series ID: EARPRXDBNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size (\$ thousands), Prime, Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EARPRXDBNQ	R-squared:	0.039
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.027
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.241
Date:	Tue, 15 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0756
Time:	15:46:24	Log-Likelihood:	-364.17
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	732.3
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	737.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	176.5714	8.976	19.671	0.000	158.704	194.438
value_fred_ATNHPIUS42020Q	0.0686	0.038	1.800	0.076	-0.007	0.144

Omnibus:	0.239	Durbin-Watson:	1.271
Prob(Omnibus):	0.887	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.081
Skew:	-0.077	Prob(JB):	0.960
Kurtosis:	3.017	Cond. No.	866.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

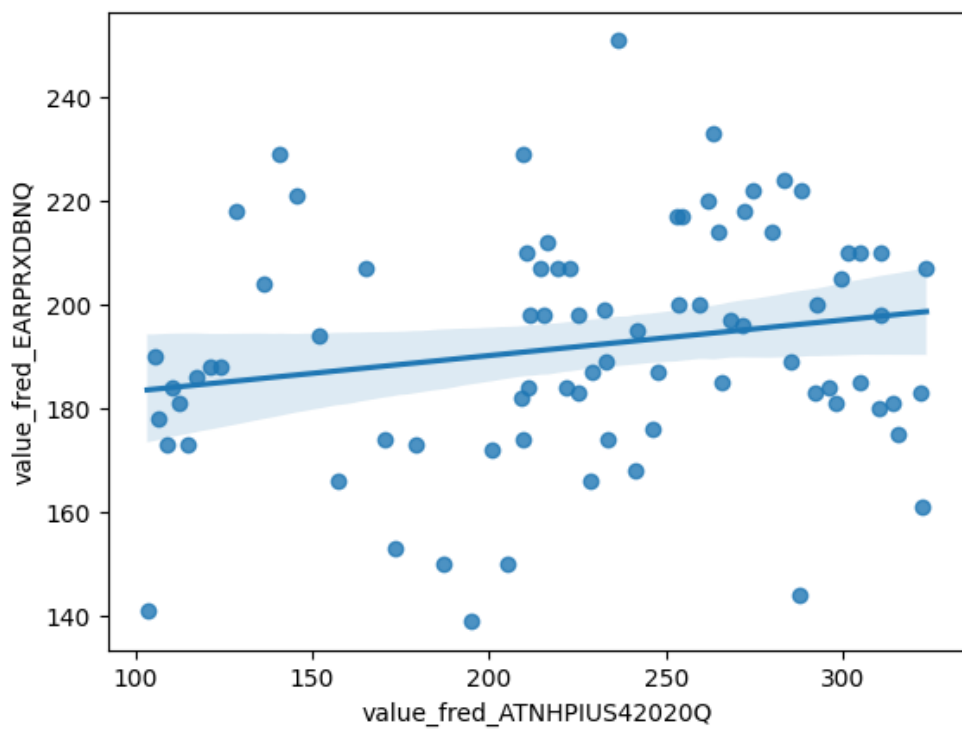


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-15

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EARPRXDBNQ_detrended	R-squared:	0.027
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.015
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.188
Date:	Tue, 15 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.143
Time:	15:46:25	Log-Likelihood:	-356.02
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	716.0
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	720.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-4.581e-12	2.207	-2.08e-12	1.000	-4.393	4.393
value_fred_ATNHPIUS42020Q_detrended	-0.0708	0.048	-1.479	0.143	-0.166	0.024

Omnibus:	1.694	Durbin-Watson:	1.556
Prob(Omnibus):	0.429	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.096
Skew:	0.241	Prob(JB):	0.578
Kurtosis:	3.303	Cond. No.	46.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

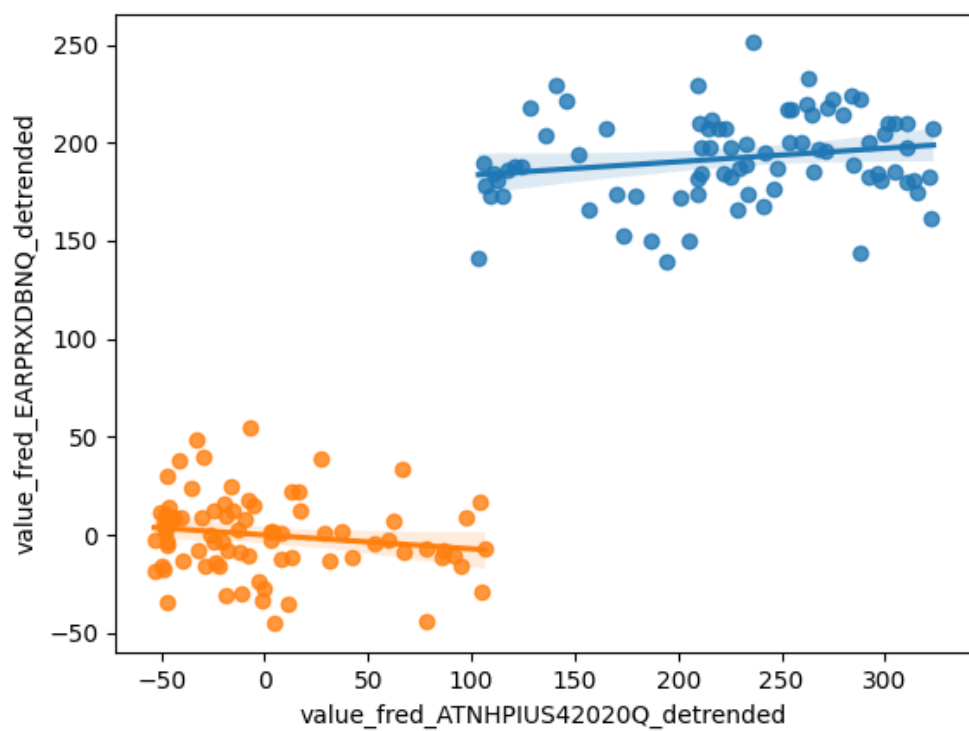


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-15

4 Date: 2026-09-16

Series ID: EMISSCO2VDFCCBA

This series is titled Distillate Fuel Commercial Sector Carbon Dioxide Emissions and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Million Metric Tons CO2 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1973-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BRVSLV02JPQ460S

This series is titled Business Tendency Surveys: Volume of Stocks: Economic Activity: Retail Trade, Except of Motor Vehicles and Motorcycles: Current for Japan and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Percentage balance and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1990-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BRVSLV02JPQ460S	R-squared:	0.481
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.465
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	29.65
Date:	Wed, 16 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.44e-06
Time:	15:39:06	Log-Likelihood:	-112.36
No. Observations:	34	AIC:	228.7
Df Residuals:	32	BIC:	231.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-20.4615	6.786	-3.015	0.005	-34.285	-6.638
value_fred_EMISSCO2VDFCCBA	1.2106	0.222	5.445	0.000	0.758	1.664

Omnibus:	6.618	Durbin-Watson:	1.027
Prob(Omnibus):	0.037	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.041
Skew:	-0.838	Prob(JB):	0.0804
Kurtosis:	3.867	Cond. No.	178.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

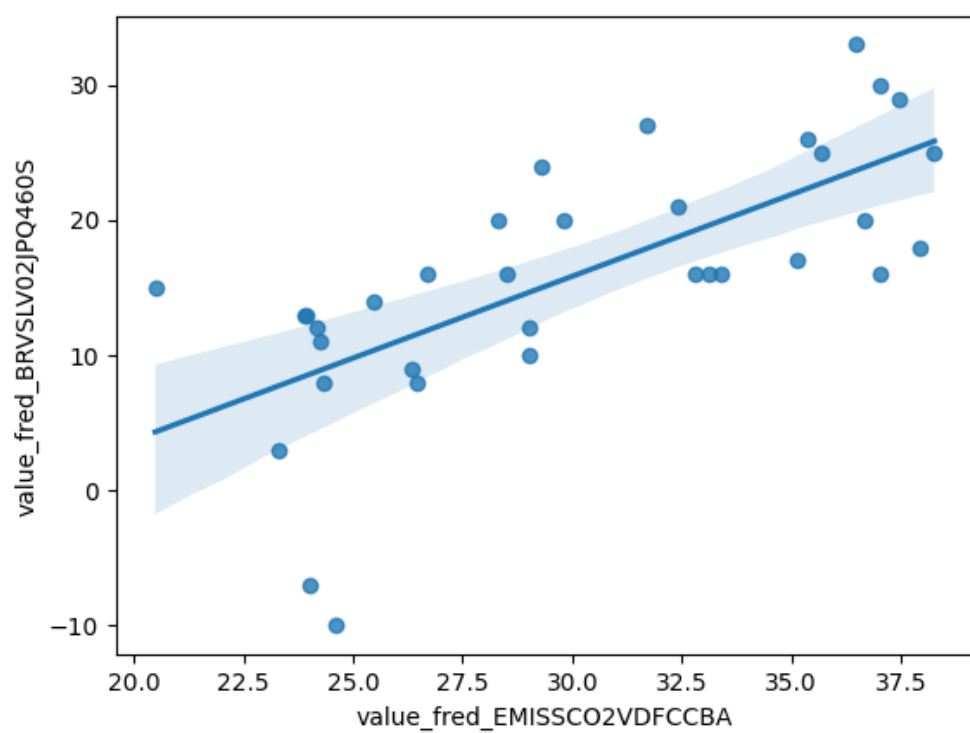


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-16

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BRVSLV02JPQ460S_detrended	R-squared:	0.166
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.140
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	6.379
Date:	Wed, 16 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0167
Time:	15:39:06	Log-Likelihood:	-100.08
No. Observations:	34	AIC:	204.2
Df Residuals:	32	BIC:	207.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-6.513e-13	0.812	-8.02e-13	1.000	-1.654	1.654
value_fred_EMISSCO2VDFCCBA_detrended	-1.0600	0.420	-2.526	0.017	-1.915	-0.205

Omnibus:	7.112	Durbin-Watson:	1.687
Prob(Omnibus):	0.029	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.544
Skew:	-0.868	Prob(JB):	0.0625
Kurtosis:	3.947	Cond. No.	1.93

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

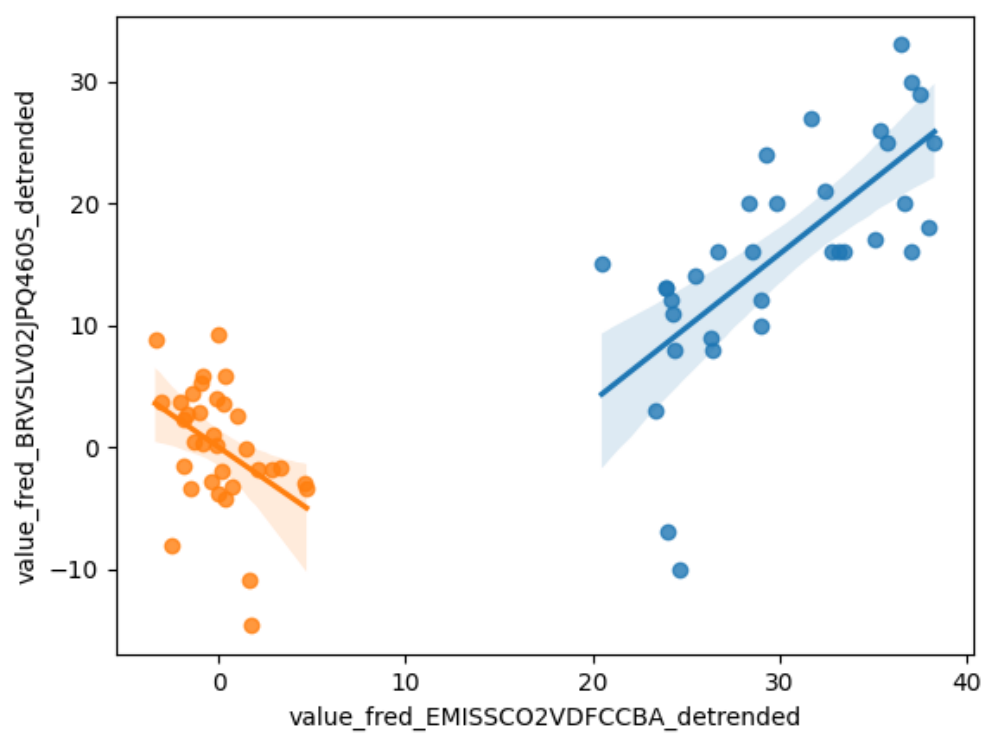


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-16